



The Lie You've Been Sold: The Slowlane

*What if I told you 'insane' was working fifty hours a week in some office
for fifty years at the end of which they tell you to piss off;
ending up in some retirement village hoping to die before suffering
the indignity of trying to make it to the toilet on time?
Wouldn't you consider **that** to be insane?*

~ STEVE BUSCEMI (CON AIR, PARAMOUNT PICTURES, 2003)

NEXT EXIT: "SLOWLANE" MEDIOCRITY AHEAD

In the previous chapter, we highlighted that a Sidewalker has no financial plan and is only concerned with the pleasures of today, often governed by instant gratification. While the Sidewalk is a chronic lifestyle that mortgages the future for a pleasurable today, the Slowlane is the antithesis: a sacrifice of today in the hopes of a brighter and freer tomorrow.

As a Slowlane traveler, you're deluged with a series of doctrines that plead discipline to the trade-off. Get a job and waste five days a week toiling at the office. Bag a lunch and stop drinking \$10 coffee. Faithfully entrust 10% of your paycheck to the stock market and your 401K. Quit dreaming about that sports car in the window because you can't buy it! Delay gratification until you're 65 years old. Save, save, save because compound interest is powerful: \$10,000 invested today will be with 10 gazillion in 50 years!

Surprisingly, the Slowlane is the first convenient exit off the Sidewalk and evolves with maturity and increased adult responsibilities. Most college graduates begin their post-schooling life on the Sidewalk. I certainly did. Graduation pardoned a license to buy stuff that yielded instant pleasure: trips to Cancun, a flashy car with